but being paved with flat stones and the water constantly running, it is fresh and clean.

The tap-room is in the court. Adjoining is the day-room, the Bell, for men and women felons. In a small court, there are two strong rooms (planked and studded with nails) for men felons; and upstairs another night-room for men, and one for women. The women's room was formerly occupied for a work-shop by a prisoner, a cooper; and the women slept in the Bell below. No straw or bedding.

On one side of the court is a chapel; with a gallery for master's-side debtors. The chapel, and indeed the whole of this prison, was quite out of repair: but at my last visit was thoroughly repaired and whitewashed. For this improvement the prisoners are obliged to the spirited and humane exertion of Mr. Sheriff Taylor.

At the roof of the prison, are spacious leads, on which the master's-side debtors are sometimes allowed to walk: but then the keeper is with them: for the leads communicate with the adjoining houses, one of which affords a ready escape from so close a prison in case of fire.

Besides the penny loaf a day, which is from the Chamber of London, there are some legacies to the debtors paid by the companies in this city, amounting to about £60 a year: they have also from the sheriffs thirty-two pounds of beef on Saturdays, and they had formerly from the Peacock brewhouse (Messrs. Calvert and Co.) a kind donation of two barrels of small beer a week.

In this prison eight men in 1776 had with them their wives and nineteen children. The other prisoners, I learned, had forty-four wives and one hundred and forty-four children, not in the gaol.

The Act for preserving the health of prisoners is not hung up. There is now painted on a board at the door, that no visitors are to be admitted on Sundays, from ten to twelve in the morning, nor from three to four in the afternoon.

The keeper pays to the Chamber of London £30 a year rent, which is refunded to him for his trouble on night-charges.[1] He also pays window-tax, etc.

[1] At this prison, as well as at New Ludgate, the Fleet, and King's Bench, I heard of the frequent visits of Dr. William Smith in 1776; who had been desired to visit the sick in the prisons of London, Westminster, and Southwark, by the committee of the Westminster charity, in consequence of their humane resolution to appropriate to this purpose the surplus of a collection made in the hard winter of 1776. Sir Charles Whitworth, the chairman, who was acquainted with the plan I had been employed on for some years, directed the doctor to apply to me for a list of the several prisons, with which I with pleasure supplied him, and at the same time informed him of my intended publication.

Dr. Smith's attention seemed to be chiefly turned towards debtors, who spoke with much esteem and gratitude of him and Mr. Cosens the apothecary, who also attended; and many beneficial effects proceeded from their management. Great alterations had taken place in prisons through the attention of Parliament before the doctor's visits; yet he discovered many abuses and frauds still practised, which he laid before the public in two pamphlets, printed for J. Bew in Paternoster Row, 1776.

WOOD STREET COMPTER

This prison, built, as appears by inscription on the front, in 1670, has only a small court or passage for all prisoners. Many apartments: yet but two rooms for common-side debtors: that for men, which is their day-room, night-room, and kitchen, with a copper, etc., is dark and dirty; about thirty-five feet by eighteen, and sixteen feet high; far too small for the number of prisoners, many of whom sleep in twenty-three beds which are on three stories of galleries, or broad shelves. At one of my visits there were in this room thirty-nine debtors: seven of them had their wives and children. The room swarms with bugs. The day- and night-room for women debtors is more lightsome: in it were only two prisoners. Beyond it is a room ruinous, and fit for no use.

For men felons there are two rooms; and two for women; one of these is a dark cell. Two dungeons, one down eleven steps, the other adjoining to the tap-room. No bedding or straw. Those who choose a bed pay 1s. a night; or else 10s. 6d. floorage, and 3s. 6d. a week. Near those four rooms are twenty-three more for master's-side debtors.

In the court is the chapel; and under it the tap-room, down sixteen steps. All the rooms aforesaid are within the inner gate; between which and the outer gate (i.e. in the keeper's house) are more rooms for master's-side debtors. No infirmary. The Act for preserving the health of prisoners not hung up. The prison is greatly out of repair; the main wall on one side shored and propped.

The keeper pays to the Chamber of London £30 a year rent, which is repaid him for his expense on night-charges: he also pays window-tax. I learned from him, that in the beginning of the year 1773 his prisoners were sickly, and eleven died. For some time the governors of the General Dispensary showed a kind attention to these poor people; and ordered their